

Running an LLM Consensus Audit

Source: **Ann Smarty, Smarty Marketing**, on Unscripted SEO with Jeremy Rivera · seoarcade.com/seo-sop-llm-consensus-audit

OBJECTIVE

Produce a single, consistent story about a business across every source a language model can reach, so that when an LLM assembles an answer about the brand it finds many independent sources saying the same thing. The deliverable is a scored inventory of every describing source, a canonical description to measure them against, and a prioritized fix list. Runs **before** profile building, outbound spend, or any community work.

"I refer to that as LLM consensus. This is when LLMs are able to find a lot of different sources about you and they are very consistent in their messaging. Don't be like me. My footprint is a mess."

Ann Smarty, Smarty Marketing

KEY STEPS

1. **Fix your own website first.** Detailed about page, real contact details, trust factors. Ann updated a 22-year-old personal site untouched for five years and saw LLM answers change. Table stakes, not the strategy.
2. **Write the canonical description.** One reference paragraph: what the business does, its value proposition, how it differs from competitors. Every other source is measured against this. Do not skip the differentiation line.
3. **Inventory every source that describes the business.** Author bios and guest post bylines, directory and review listings, social and platform profiles, speaker and event pages, partner pages, press, and profiles from earlier eras of the company. Capture URL, description carried, and who controls it.
4. **Score each source against the canonical.** Agrees / contradicts / stale. Contradictions outrank gaps: a source describing a business you no longer are forces the model to reconcile competing claims and it may surface the wrong one.
5. **Fix in order of reachability.** Three passes: editable now, needs credential recovery, needs a third party to change it. (*inferred*) Credential recovery is usually the real bottleneck and deserves separate scoping.
6. **Close the internal gap.** Interview sales and support, compare against the website. Ann: a large share of reputation damage comes from that mismatch, and it surfaces on Reddit then everywhere downstream. Undisclosed upfront pricing is the worked example.
7. **Map the competitor citation gap.** Channels driving LLM citations for competitors where you are absent. Usual list: Reddit, YouTube, Wikipedia, a few high-profile publications. Do not dismiss directory submissions; LLMs use them heavily now.
8. **Build the contribution system, set a re-audit cadence.** One asset can be a good update for ten profiles. Then put the audit back on the calendar. The fix list is never empty.

CAUTIONARY NOTES

- **Scope by company age.** Takes a lot of time; older businesses take longest. Quote and staff accordingly.
- **It is never finished.** Sell a maintained state, not a project that closes.
- **Expect to lose the alignment fight ~50% of the time.** Executives will not publish what they believe is how they make money. Have a plan B: build authority around the constraint, not through it.
- **One citation is not consensus.** A single mention will not put a brand in AI answers, and citations are not even clicked. Presence in the answer is the goal.
- **Do not skip the owned site.** It is where the canonical description lives.
- **Audit before outbound spend.** Ads into an unaudited footprint just fund faster discovery of what is already there.

TIPS FOR EFFICIENCY

- **Run it in-house.** Ann says so directly. The constraint is time, not tooling or licence cost.
- **Recycle one asset across ten profiles.** This is what turns the fix list into a system.
- **AI for direction, not for the reading.** Ann connects Semrush or Ahrefs into Claude for angles, then still spends three days to a week reading actual search results by hand before writing a roadmap.
- **Start from organic search data.** Prompts are not observable; keyword data is the best available proxy.
- **Pair with one sustainable weekly habit.** Ann's is a Wednesday live stream, and she credits that consistency alone with driving a lot of business.

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